when they computed their income tax the following year, to send a check for only ninety percent of what they owed.

When the legislators heard that, they went wild. But it was too late; the people knew about the surplus. They wanted it back—and they got it back.

By the spring of 1968, I was really starting to enjoy my new job. The ulcer was gone (no evidence of it ever returned) and I was making some progress on the things I wanted to accomplish. Nancy and I weren't ready for another round of pressure to run for office, but that's what we got. It had started shortly after we came to Sacramento: I'd give a speech and afterward there'd be a cluster of people who'd be waiting to talk to me and they would urge me to run for president. I'd always said I wasn't interested.

Then early in 1968, several leaders of the state Republican party came to see me and said they wanted me to run for the Republican presidential nomination on the California primary ballot the following June as a favorite-son candidate. If I did, he said the party could avert a repeat of the kind of bloody battle between moderates and conservatives that split the party so badly in 1964.

I agreed with them that there were still lots of hard feelings left over from the Goldwater-Rockefeller primary fight and that a heated primary race between the three major candidates in 1968—Richard Nixon, Nelson Rockefeller, and George Romney—would probably reopen the wounds. But running for president was the last thing on my mind. I'd been governor for less than two years and I said it would look ridiculous if I ran for president.

But they countered: "A favorite-son candidate is not the same thing as a *real* candidate. If you enter the primary as a favorite son, the major candidates won't enter the race, so we'll avoid a disastrous primary fight; as governor, you'll win the primary, but that only means you'll head the delegation to the convention."